

Virginia Turner

Favorite food



Barbecued brisket is a big favorite with Chamber of Commerce guests, convention delegates and others who use the Civic Center, according to Tom Meehan, director of food and beverage service for Servomation-Duchess, the caterer.

Meehan is probably one of the most unflappable people in El Paso. He's accustomed to last minute crises and takes them all in stride. Usually everything goes off smoothly because when a party is arranged for, he runs through every minute of the planned event with the committee, takes note of the budget and plans to fit their pocketbooks.

ONCE IN A WHILE there's a hitch. The big Head Start convention this year brought in some 2,600 delegates from all 50 states, and Washington VIPs. "We had the sit-down time at 7:30 p.m. but the program listed it as 7 p.m.," he recalled. "Susan Coldwell, the local co-ordinator came in and said, 'We're ready to eat at 7 p.m.' Well, we compromised. We got ready 15 minutes early and everyone was served in 38 minutes. We had a staff of about 80 for that one, which was the largest we'd had in the Civic Center so far.

"In addition to brisket, another favorite is filet mignon with mushroom sauce. Everyone accepts that and it's a favorite with the ladies. The pocket-book favorite is top chopped sirloin of beef with mushroom sauce. We have a semi coarse grinder and cut out all the fat so it has a real steak flavor. We cut all our own steaks too. We have a tremendous variety in food service with anything from chips and dips to full course dinners. We cater outside parties, too.

"Leftovers? We give all salvageable food to the Salvation Army."

Meehan has been in the food organization business for 27 years. He started in Denver and moved quite a lot with different food organizations. He's been in El Paso 16 years. Servomation is a San Diego based operation.

"There's nothing we can't produce," he said.

Eric Alwan, the 13-year-old son of Mr. and Mrs. Dick Alwan, is back in the limelight again. This time he's been invited to join 50 handicappers at a track, Penn National, near Harrisburg, Pa. for a three-day showdown. Twenty-five of the handicappers are big league media persons (Eric is in that group) and 25 others will be selected from preliminaries. Anyhow, each will start with a make-believe \$1,000 betting fund. After three race days (30 races) the one who winds up with the most money on paper will be declared the champion. There will be a top prize of \$7,800 and lesser prizes

for places down to the fifth. Penn National is paying all expenses to fly Eric and his parents to the track for the event scheduled Oct. 27-Nov. 1. It's the fifth all-expense paid trip for Eric in less than a year. He has appeared on many talk and contest shows in the East, a result of his horse-racing knowhow. He publishes the Eager Beaver tip sheet at Sunland Park. "People Magazine called me," proud father Alwan said. "The magazine wants me to keep it posted in the event Eric wins. But that's a real long shot."

Mrs. Josefa Romo Rangel, who will be 105 years old on Feb. 23, does hand work, reads with a reading glass and walks with the aid of a walker. She recently moved to Four Seasons Nursing Home and was named Resident of the Month by Frances Freeman, who wrote a story about her in the October issue of the Dispatch, a monthly news bulletin she edits. Mrs. Rangel fled Mexico with her husband and mother in 1910 during the revolution, leaving all their property. They operated two grocery stores here until 1933 when Mr. Rangel died. She then operated one and leased the other for a number of years. Her mother, Mrs. Romo, lived with the Rangel family for 40 years until her death in 1953 at age 95. The Rangels had three sons and a daughter and their eldest son, Sal, attended El Paso High School. He was a member of the first El Paso basketball team to win the State of Texas Championship in 1921-22 under the late Coach Luther Coblentz. Andy Cohen, the present baseball coach at U.T. El Paso, was another member of the team.

Leon and Tommie Gillespie returned last night with a group of 61 members of the Empire Club from a week-long trip to Hawaii and island-hopping. Travelers included members who have moved from El Paso but still retain their membership, and included vacationers from Silver City, Lordsburg, Las Cruces, Albuquerque, Denver, Clarksdale, Ariz., Tyler, Tex. and Los Angeles.

Gershon Ettinger, founder and president of Regal Supply and Chemical, has been selected by the National Association of Wholesaler-Distributors board to represent the International Sanitary Supply Association on the governing body, the Board of Trustees, for 1978.

"Glasses can change your personality completely...if you empty them often enough." And, "My mother was always dieting. To this day I think of a home-cooked meal as grapefruit and black coffee."—Texas Tourist Council's Tourist Talk, written by Don Epperson, Executive Director.